

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, October 22 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept the minutes of the September 30, 2025 City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway –Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Greenrose and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept the minutes of the October 08, 2025 City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway –Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Supervisor Check list Saturday October 25th from 11:00am 11:30am.

Saturday October 25th there will be a spooky ride at Moody Park from 4:00pm to 6:00pm.

Municipal elections will be November 4th voting.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

Manager bates states long time City Clerk Gloria Deschaines passed away In September.

Mayor Girard requested a moment of silence to honor Mrs. Deschaines.

Manager Bates updates the council on Washington Street Traffic lights, nothing has been altered however there can be delays due to bicycles and walking traffic or intersections. This will continue to be monitored.

Manager bates informs the council of the 17 Water Street sales are moving along, buyer is asking for extension which is permitted in the purchase and sales agreement.

Manager Bates states CDA does not need the two hundred thousand before the council meeting; already prepared for November 12, 2025 council meeting agenda.

Manager Bates confirms Water sewer paper bills will be going out on October 29th, online billing should be available already or by tomorrow.

Manager Bates confirms Auditors will be here next week for FY 2025 audit.

Manager Bates speaks on Tax rate setting; nearly all the reports have been submitted to DRA for the tax rate setting including the school reports. The last remaining reports should be submitted by the end of next week. Once the preliminary rate is set it will be presented to the council for final approval which will include the approval of the overlay amount.

Manager Bates follows up on a Councilor inquiry weather or not the Planning board requires one meeting a month; the answer is yes pursuant of RSA 67:310.

Manager Bates follows up on a Councilor inquiry confirming that the information of tax relief is printed on our tax bills.

Manager Bates informs the Council we received our last bill for Washington street which including the overage.

DPW is currently surveying street lights. There will be a link on the website to an Eversource request from where anyone can report a street light that is staying on or not working.

Manager bates received a lease agreement for a private hanger at the Airport. Currently under review that will be presented at the next council meeting.

Manager Bates follows up on a Councilor Inquiry for the Broad Street Cemetery, 3 quotes have been received for the work. Updates for lowest quote came in at eight thousand one hundred dollars. The contractor is available to do work now.

The Council gives Manager Bates permission to move forward with the repairs at the cemetery.

Manager Bates states two unions are up for negotiations this year.

Manager Bates follows up on a Councilor inquiry regarding Loud backfire exhausts. Since January 1st the PD has issued eleven motor vehicle citations for illegal exhausts, five criminal complaints for disorderly conduct related to backfiring vehicles.

Manager Bates states the Planning director will be recommending a modification to the Noise ordinance soon.

Manager Bates states the Rail trail railing has been fixed.

Manager Bates announces Leaf pick up and chair removal will be the first week of November.

Manager Bates invites Brian Colburn from McFarland Johnson to present on updates for North and Main to the council.

Mr. Brian Coburn to provide and update to council on what to expect over the next couple of weeks and the 2026 construction season.

Mr. Brian Coburn the project manager states paving 4 days next week expect detours. Striping company will be doing work Tuesday or Wednesday the week after also guard rail, signs. Update of the next month or so. See presentation on the CCTV or the City Facebook page.

Councilor Koloski thanks Mr. Coburn for the update. Koloski voices concerns that he does not want the council to lose sight of downtown entirely.

Mayor Girard inquires about changes and budget.

Mr. Coburn responds with the budget will be close.

Councilor Koloski asks for clarification if it is water or water and sewer lines that need relocating.

Councilor Koloski inquires about Washington street fiber optic cables across the Walmart intersection on the traffic signals. Councilor Koloski asks for an update of the Community Center Roof, three sections that are buckling up and raised. Councilor Koloski asked for clarification on the airport lease.

Councilor Limoges asked if we are using new voting machines. If there is anything the public needs to know.

Councilor O'Hearne references street lights and asks for clarification on the plan moving forward.

Manager bates states this will not affect overtime for highway on the light survey.

Mayor Girard confirms Eversource has been out there

Councilor O'Hearne voices concerns of light on Broad and Glidden Street as he has witnessed people running the light.

Councilor Greenrose has concerns about plowing around crosswalks.

Councilor Koloski recommends documenting the time the light has been on. Councilor Koloski also asks the city reevaluate how we provide mailing to all the boards and commissions as it is \$11.90 each then times that by all the members.

Manager Bates states there was approved money for this year to move to electronic agendas for all boards and committees.

Director Martin met with the gentlemen that spoke at citizens forum relating to better access for motorized scooters and lighting at Monadnock Park. Updates will follow.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard opened the forum at 7:12pm

No one spoke forum was closed 7:12pm

OLD BUSINESS

AMTRACK Train Station Presentation – Charlene Lovett

NOTES

Charlene Lovett ward II – introduces Chuck, Maggie May and Sharron woods.

Over the last 8 years the volunteers have been helping passengers get to the next leg of their journey. We are the most popular spot to get on and off. Porta potty since there is nothing there at the station. Bench from the rotary club. Car dealer ships, we have folks to come for dealerships. 2018 since.

Chuck Allen fall of 2018 close to 5000 stops since 2018. Ask chuck if he would like to provide what he presented.

Councilor Greenrose attests to the wonderful assistance at the station. Greatly appreciated. Inquires if the volunteers are aware of a quiet zone based on federal law, if you have right cross gates you cannot have a horn.

Mrs. Lovett will investigate the quiet zone Councilor Greenrose referenced.

Councilor Koloski thanks for all you do. Councilor Koloski asked for clarification on which line was being used. Councilor Koloski asks Mrs. Lovett if there is anything for donations the volunteer group could use.

Mrs. Lovett will get back to the council on needs.

Ordinance 641 Veterans Tax Credit – Second Reading

DISCUSSION

Councilor Hemingway recuses himself.

Director Hamilton Presents Ordinance 641 to Council.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #641

PROPERTY TAX CREDIT FOR VETERANS

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to New Hampshire RSA 72:35, the Claremont City Code is hereby amended to revise Article II, Division 2 of Chapter 18 as follows:

Section 1. Property Tax Credit for Veterans

Sec. 18-44 Credit for totally disabled veterans.

Revise subsection (a) of Section 18-44 to increase the annual benefit, for a tax credit on real estate taxes owed, provided to qualified veterans or their surviving spouses, due to a recent statutory change that prohibits the “stacking” of this exemption with the veterans’ exemption set forth in RSA 72:28, so that the provision shall read as follows:

- (a) In accordance with RSA 72:35, the city shall provide any veteran who has been honorably discharged or an officer honorably separated from military service and who has a total and permanent service-connected disability, or who is a double amputee or paraplegic because of service-connected injury, or the surviving spouse of such person a credit each year from tax on his/her residential real estate in the amount of one thousand nine hundred dollars (\$1,900.00). Any individual who qualifies for and receives this tax credit shall not be eligible for the tax credit provided in Sec. 18-43 pursuant to the provisions of RSA 72:35.

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 18, Article II, Division 2, Section 18-44 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect for purposes of accepting applications under the increased credit amount immediately upon passage and any such approved tax credits, for said qualified veterans (or surviving spouse), shall be applied to the tax year commencing April 1, 2026.

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Koloski to approve Ordinance 641

Councilor Hayden asks for clarification.

Director Hamilton states maximum to \$750.00. Suggests the policy committee meet on the matter.

Manager Bates currently we offer \$500.00 credits for veterans. If this the maximum is raised we would have to raise that money through other taxpayers.

Roll call

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Recused

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 8-1

Ordinance 642 Elderly Tax Exemption – Second Reading

DISCUSSION

Director Hamilton explains ordinance.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #642

PROPERTY TAX EXEMPTIONS FOR ELDERLY

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to New Hampshire RSA 72:27-a, RSA 72-39-a and RSA 72-39-b, the Claremont City Code is hereby amended to revise Article II, Division 4 of Chapter 18 as follows:

Section 1. Property Tax Exemption for Elderly

Sec. 18-58 (4). Exemption amount and qualifications.

Revise Subsection (4) of Section 18-58 to increase the qualifying net income and asset limits so that the provision shall read as follows:

(4) To qualify, an unmarried taxpayer must have a net income of not more than twenty-eight thousand four hundred dollars (\$28,400.00), or if married, must have a combined net income of not more than thirty-seven thousand five hundred dollars (\$37,500.00). Net assets for either an unmarried taxpayer or, if married, combined assets must be not more than seventy-seven thousand six hundred dollars (\$77,600.00), exclusive of the value of the taxpayer's residence and the land upon which it is located up to the greater of two (2) acres or the minimum single-family residential lot specified in the Claremont Zoning Ordinance for the zone in which the property lies. The combined net asset amount shall apply to a surviving spouse until the sale or transfer of the property by the surviving spouse or until the remarriage of the surviving spouse.

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 18, Article II, Division 4, Section 18-58 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect for purposes of accepting applications under the increased limits immediately upon passage and shall be enforced for property tax exemptions for the elderly for the tax year commencing April 1, 2026.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Zutter to approve ordinance 642.

Roll call:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway –Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion Carried – 9-0

Ordinance 643 Disabled Tax Exemption - Second Reading

DISCUSSION

Mr. Hamilton explains ordinance.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #643

PROPERTY TAX EXEMPTION FOR THE DISABLED

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to New Hampshire RSA 72:27-a and RSA 72:37-b, the Claremont City Code is hereby amended to revise Article II, Division 3 of Chapter 18 as follows:

Section 1. Property Tax Exemption for the Disabled

Sec. 18-53. Exemption for the disabled.

Revise Subsections (a), (2) and (3) of Section 18-53 to modify net income and asset qualification standards to read as follows:

- (a) In accordance with New Hampshire RSA 72:37-b, the city shall provide for the exemption for disabled persons from property tax, that every inhabitant who is entitled shall be granted a thirty-five thousand dollars (\$35,000.00) property value exemption based upon the following additional eligibility criteria:
- (2) Applicant must have had, in the calendar year preceding April 1 of the year in which the exemption is claimed, an annual net income from all sources of less than twenty-five thousand four hundred dollars (\$25,400.00), if single, [or] a combined annual net income of less than thirty-four thousand three hundred dollars (\$34,300.00), if married. Such net income is to be determined by deducting from all monies received from any source whatsoever the amount or sum of any life insurance paid on the death of an insured, expenses and costs incurred in the course of conducting a business enterprise, [and/or] proceeds from the sale of assets; and
 - (3) Applicant's net assets, as defined in RSA 72:37-b III(b), excluding the value of the residence and the land upon which it is located up to the greater of two (2) acres or the minimum single family residential lot size for that zone as specified in the city's zoning ordinance, must not exceed forty-five thousand three hundred dollars (\$45,300.00).

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 18, Article II, Division 3, Section 18-53 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect for purposes of accepting applications under the increased limits immediately upon passage and shall be enforced for property tax exemptions for the disabled for the tax year commencing April 1, 2026.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Koloski to approve Ordinance 643.

Roll call:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried – 9-0

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2026-20 VOCA Grant – Public Hearing

DISCUSSION

Deputy Chief Allen explains resolution and introduces Mrs. Whitman.

Mrs. Whitman relays her desires to stay here and Claremont and continue to support these families and individuals she has been able to help.

Short discussion followed.

RESOLUTION 2026-20

Department of Justice VOCA Grant

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has been awarded a United States Department of Justice Victims of Crime Act (VOCA) Grant in the amount of \$40,000.00 for a six-month period to fund the position of ACERT Coordinator. This position facilitates the Adverse Childhood Experiences Response Team (ACERT) for the Greater Claremont Area; and

WHEREAS, if accepted, the City of Claremont, New Hampshire would have a \$10,000 matching requirement, of which approximately \$5,000.00 would be from in-kind funding, and \$5,000 would be a cash match; and

WHEREAS, the matching funds will be absorbed in the FY26 Police Budget, thereby causing no additional impact on the tax rate.

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend the funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or her designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept a grant in the amount of \$40,000.00 from the United States Department of Justice to fund the ACERT Coordinator position; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or her designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 22nd day of October 2025, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept Resolution 2026-20.

Roll call:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – Yes

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Koloski – Arts – was unable to attend the last meeting. During 250th celebration Joy foundry molds ended up in a private residence, those are being returned to the city.

Councilor Greenrose – Energy – Presentation by clean energy NH on clean community power.

Mayor Girard inquires about committee size and being able to meet quorum.
Greenrose bare minimum for quorum.

Councilor Limoges – CDA- Special meeting last Friday for greenhouse project, there is a bit of difficulty with power cable and how that will be tackled, wetlands have shifted. Extend a 30 day deadline to wait for the power company.

Assistant Mayor Matteau – Planning - Met and approved two subdivisions.
Hayden – Conservation – ink factory cleanup day was a big success.

Mayor Girard recommends reducing the size of EPA to be able to meet quorum.

Councilor O’Hearne – Francis J. Tolles Home – was unable to make it to last meeting.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Manager Bates informs of Potential spotlight. This would be aired on CNN, PBS and other national networks. Mrs. Bates is looking for the go ahead and pursue more information.

Councilor Hayden adds Nosie violations for loud exhausts.

Councilor Koloski raises concern about computer chip in regards to loud exhausts. Would like to hear from law enforcement to see if this is covered by Current or new state statute.

Councilor Hayden adds Veterans Park softball park avoiding parking in the parking lot.

Councilor Greenrose suggests altering size of committees be an agenda item.

Councilor Koloski motion to rescind future agenda item board of assessors.

Councilor Hemingway discussion with us for veteran’s tax policy.

Manager Bates asks for permission to continue conversation with viewpoint.

Koloski would like to know the number that this would cost the city.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:22 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes
Hemingway – Yes
Hayden – Yes
O’Hearne – Yes
Girard – Yes
Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Jamie DeRosa
Acting Clerk to the Council